

The Manicure & Pedicure — Step by Step

The complete professional service, and the experience that turns a polish change into an Amber service

Learning Objectives

- Perform the complete Amber manicure and pedicure protocol from setup through finish
- Sequence cuticle care, shaping, and polish correctly to avoid product contamination
- Apply correct massage technique as a genuine part of the service, not an afterthought
- Check a finished service for a professional, even, fully cured result

Nine steps, one coherent service

As with every step-by-step protocol in this Atelier, each stage sets up the one after it.

Skipping the soften step makes cuticle work rougher than it needs to be; rushing the shape step undermines even the most careful polish application. Work the sequence in full, every time.

Step 1 · Station and sterilization

Set up a fully sterilized and disinfected station per Module Nine before the client sits down — never assembled hastily while she waits.

Step 2 · Consultation and assessment

Recap the plan from consultation, and perform the nail assessment from Module Three, adjusting the planned service if anything observed calls for it.

Step 3 · Remove old product and shape

Remove any existing polish, gel, or extension using correct method (soak-off only for gel/acrylic, per Module Six), then shape the free edge using single-direction filing to the client's chosen shape from Module Two's natural bed guidance.

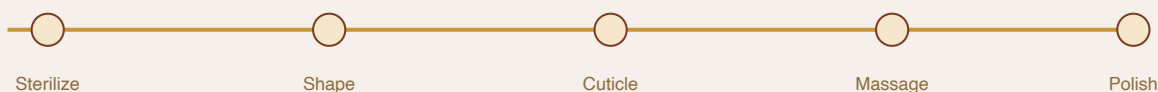
Step 4 · Soak and soften

Soak hands or feet briefly in warm water to soften the cuticle before any cuticle work begins — never attempt cuticle care on dry, unsoftened skin.

Step 5 · Cuticle care

Apply cuticle remover, then gently push back the softened cuticle, removing only visibly loose, dead tissue with a nipper — never cutting the living seal, per Module Six.

◆ Figure 11.1 · The Nine-Step Sequence



Each step prepares the surface and the client for the one that follows — never reorder the sequence to save time.

Step 6 · Exfoliate and massage

For pedicures, gently address calluses with a foot file (never a blade-based credo tool, which most jurisdictions restrict or prohibit due to injury risk), then perform a genuine hand or foot and lower leg massage using the unhurried pressure and traditional oils from Module Five — this step is not filler; it is frequently the moment a client remembers most.

Step 7 · Prep the nail plate

Wipe the nail plate clean of all oil and moisture residue immediately before polish — any trace of oil is the single most common cause of premature polish lifting.

Step 8 · Polish, gel, or extension

Apply base coat, colour (thin, even coats, allowing appropriate dry or cure time between each per Module Four), and top coat, curing fully under the lamp at each stage if using a gel system — never shortening cure time to save minutes.

Step 9 · Finish and check

Apply cuticle oil to the finished nail, check for full cure and even coverage in good light, and close with brief aftercare guidance — cuticle oil frequency, and correct removal timing.

Key Terms

0

[object Object]

1

[object Object]

Practical Activity · The Full Protocol

Perform a complete manicure or pedicure on a partner or model, narrating each of the nine steps aloud. Have an observer note anything skipped or rushed. **Photograph the finished result — this becomes part of your capstone portfolio.**